

Strawberries

FRESH -> PRESERVED

Fresh: Fresh Willamette Valley strawberries - in season mid-May through

Preserved: Strawberry Rhubarb preserves (Water bath canning)

In season (Willamette Valley): Mid-May through late June

Yield: 4 cups sliced strawberries + rhubarb and sugar yield about 10 half-pint jars preserves

Strawberries paired with tart rhubarb make a perfect balance in homemade preserves. Follow safe water bath canning steps to preserve freshness and flavor for winter enjoyment.

Wow: A good strawberry-rhubarb preserve can yield 10 half-pint jars from 4 cups each of fruit.

Source: OSU Extension MFP

Green Beans

FRESH -> PRESERVED

Fresh: Fresh, young Willamette Valley green beans - peak harvest July

Preserved: Whole canned green beans (Pressure canning)

In season (Willamette Valley): July through September

Yield: 11/2 to 21/2 pounds of beans per quart jar; about 12-20 quarts from 30 pounds (1 bushel)

Canning green beans requires pressure canning to ensure safety.

Use young, tender beans and pack them hot or raw into jars.

Follow the exact processing times for altitude.

Wow: One bushel of fresh green beans yields up to 20 quarts of canned beans.

Source: OSU Extension MFP

Peaches

FRESH -> PRESERVED

Fresh: Fresh Willamette Valley freestone peaches - in season July thro

Preserved: Canned peach halves in syrup (Water bath canning)

In season (Willamette Valley): July through September

Yield: 2 to 3 pounds fresh peaches per quart jar; about 18-24 quarts per bushel (48 pounds)

Freestone yellow peaches are preferred for home canning. Peel, pit, slice and pack in syrup before processing in boiling water canner. Do not can white-flesh peaches due to safety concerns.

Wow: Canning peaches in syrup helps them hold shape and quality better than raw pack.

Source: OSU Extension MFP

Cucumbers

FRESH -> PRESERVED

Fresh: Fresh Willamette Valley cucumbers - in season June through August

Preserved: Pickled cucumbers (Water bath canning (pickling))

In season (Willamette Valley): June through August

Yield: About 10 pounds cucumbers to 9 pints pickles

Pickled cucumbers can be safely canned using tested recipes with vinegar acid levels to prevent spoilage. Use fresh crisp cucumbers and process in boiling water canner.

Wow: Home pickled cucumbers combine vinegar, salt, and spices for a tangy, crunchy treat.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

Raspberries

FRESH -> PRESERVED

Fresh: Fresh Willamette Valley raspberries - in season June through Ju

Preserved: Frozen raspberries (Freezing)

In season (Willamette Valley): June through July

Yield: 2 pounds fresh raspberries freeze to about 2 pounds frozen berries

Select ripe, juicy raspberries; wash gently and drain. Pack individually quick-frozen or in syrup. Use within a year for best quality.

Wow: Raspberries can be frozen whole or as purée with ascorbic acid to maintain color and flavor.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables

Tomatoes

FRESH -> PRESERVED

Fresh: Fresh Willamette Valley tomatoes - in season July through Septe

Preserved: Whole canned tomatoes (Water bath canning)

In season (Willamette Valley): July through September

Yield: About 2 1/2 to 3 pounds tomatoes per quart jar

Select ripe, firm tomatoes; blanch and peel. Pack in hot water or juice with lemon juice to ensure safe pH. Process in boiling water canner with recommended time.

Wow: Adding bottled lemon juice ensures safe acidity for canned tomatoes.

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products

Zucchini

FRESH -> PRESERVED

Fresh: Fresh Willamette Valley zucchini - in season July through September

Preserved: Frozen zucchini slices (Freezing)

In season (Willamette Valley): July through September

Yield: About 1 pound fresh zucchini yields about 1 pound frozen zucchini

Trim, wash, slice zucchini. Blanch in boiling water for 3 minutes, cool in ice water, drain, and pack in freezer containers. Label and use within one year.

Wow: Blanch zucchini slices for 3 minutes before freezing to retain flavor and texture.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables

Basil

FRESH -> PRESERVED

Fresh: Fresh Willamette Valley basil - harvest July through September

Preserved: Dehydrated basil leaves (Drying)

In season (Willamette Valley): July through September

Yield: About 6 cups fresh leaves yield 1 cup dried herbs

Harvest fresh basil leaves, wash, and dry quickly. Spread thinly to dry. Store in airtight containers away from light and heat for up to one year.

Wow: Basil can be dried using kitchen dehydrators or air drying in shaded, airy space.

Source: OSU Extension MFP

Apples

FRESH -> PRESERVED

Fresh: Fresh Willamette Valley apples - peak season September through

Preserved: Canned spiced apple slices (Water bath canning)

In season (Willamette Valley): September through November

Yield: About 2 to 3 pounds apples per quart jar

Select crisp apples. Peel, core, and slice. Prepare a boiling syrup and pack apples hot. Process in boiling water canner according to recipe.

Wow: Adding lemon juice to apple slices prevents browning prior to packing.

Source: OSU Extension MFP

Cherries

FRESH -> PRESERVED

Fresh: Fresh Willamette Valley cherries - peak season June through Jul

Preserved: Cherry jam (Water bath canning)

In season (Willamette Valley): June through July

Yield: Approximately 4 cups crushed cherries make 4 half-pint jars jam

Crush cherries and cook with sugar and commercial pectin for best results. Pour into hot sterilized jars and process promptly in a water bath canner.

Wow: Cherries are low in pectin; commercial pectin helps jam gel well.

Source: OSU Extension MFP

Rhubarb

FRESH -> PRESERVED

Fresh: Fresh Willamette Valley rhubarb stalks - in season April through

Preserved: Frozen rhubarb chunks (Freezing)

In season (Willamette Valley): April through June

Yield: About 2 pounds fresh rhubarb yield 2 pounds frozen

Wash, trim, and cut into 1/2-inch pieces. Blanch for 1 minute and cool quickly, or freeze raw. Pack into freezer containers with 1/2-inch headspace.

Wow: Rhubarb chunks can be frozen raw or blanched briefly to preserve color.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables

Blueberries

FRESH -> PRESERVED

Fresh: Fresh Willamette Valley blueberries - in season July through Au

Preserved: Dehydrated blueberries (Drying)

In season (Willamette Valley): July through August

Yield: Approximately 4 cups fresh blueberries yield 1 cup dried blueberries

Wash blueberries and dry thoroughly. Use a dehydrator at recommended temperatures until completely dry. Store in airtight containers.

Wow: Dried blueberries are a natural, shelf-stable ingredient for cereals and baking.

Source: OSU Extension MFP

Carrots

FRESH -> PRESERVED

Fresh: Fresh Willamette Valley carrots - available year-round, peak su

Preserved: Frozen sliced carrots (Freezing)

In season (Willamette Valley): July through October

Yield: About 1 pound fresh carrots yields 1 pound frozen carrots

Wash, peel, and slice carrots. Blanch in boiling water for 5 minutes. Cool rapidly in ice water and pack in freezer containers.

Wow: Carrots require blanching for 5 minutes before freezing to maintain quality.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables

Cabbage

FRESH -> PRESERVED

Fresh: Fresh Willamette Valley cabbage - available August through Nove

Preserved: Sauerkraut (fermented cabbage) (Fermentation)

In season (Willamette Valley): August through November

Yield: 16 pounds fresh cabbage yields about 1 gallon sauerkraut

Shred cabbage, mix with salt, and pack tightly in fermentation vessel. Allow to ferment at cool room temperature for 2-4 weeks.

Store sauerkraut refrigerated after fermentation.

Wow: Sauerkraut fermentation produces lactic acid which naturally preserves and adds tangy flavor.

Source: OSU Extension MFP

Chili Peppers

FRESH -> PRESERVED

Fresh: Fresh Willamette Valley hot peppers - in season August through

Preserved: Frozen chopped hot peppers (Freezing)

In season (Willamette Valley): August through October

Yield: 1 pound fresh peppers yields roughly 1 pound frozen

Wash peppers, remove stems and seeds if desired. Chop or freeze whole in bags. Use gloves during preparation.

Wow: Peppers can be frozen whole or chopped, no blanching required for hot types.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables

Garlic

FRESH -> PRESERVED

Fresh: Fresh Willamette Valley garlic - available summer through fall

Preserved: Dehydrated garlic flakes (Drying)

In season (Willamette Valley): July through October

Yield: About 10 bulbs fresh garlic yield 1 cup dried flakes

Peel cloves and slice thinly. Dry in dehydrator until brittle. Store in airtight container away from light and heat.

Wow: Dried garlic flakes rehydrate quickly and can be used like fresh garlic.

Source: OSU Extension MFP

Plums

FRESH -> PRESERVED

Fresh: Fresh Willamette Valley plums - in season August through September

Preserved: Canned plum halves in syrup (Water bath canning)

In season (Willamette Valley): August through September

Yield: Approximately 2 pounds fresh plums per quart jar

Wash, pit, and halve plums. Pack in syrup or water with boiling water canner processing times. Use lemon juice as needed to ensure acidity.

Wow: Plums can also be frozen whole or as purée safely.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables

Pear

FRESH -> PRESERVED

Fresh: Fresh Willamette Valley pears - peak season September through November

Preserved: Canned pear halves in syrup (Water bath canning)

In season (Willamette Valley): September through November

Yield: Approximately 2 pounds fresh pears per quart jar

Select firm ripe pears; peel, core, and halve. Heat in boiling syrup, drain, cool and pack in syrup or water before canning.

Wow: Pears should be blanched in boiling syrup before packing to soften and retain quality.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables

Onions

FRESH -> PRESERVED

Fresh: Fresh Willamette Valley onions - available year-round, peak summer

Preserved: Frozen diced onions (Freezing)

In season (Willamette Valley): June through August

Yield: About 1 pound fresh onions yield 1 pound frozen onions

Peel and dice onions. Blanch for 3-7 minutes, cool quickly, drain, and freeze in sealed containers or bags.

Wow: Onions can be frozen raw or blanched for longer storage.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables

Blackberries

FRESH -> PRESERVED

Fresh: Fresh Willamette Valley blackberries-peak season July through August

Preserved: Blackberry jam (Water bath canning)

In season (Willamette Valley): July through August

Yield: 2 cups crushed blackberries yield about 4 half-pint jars jam

Blackberries can be canned whole in syrup or preserved as jam using crushed berries for a thick, spreadable fruit preserve. Use ripe, sweet berries for the best flavor and follow boiling water canning guidelines for safety. Freezing berries in sugar syrup helps retain firmness, but jam is perfect for spreading on toast or adding to desserts.

Wow: Fresh berries yield about half as many quarts when frozen or canned whole, but jams concentrate the flavor and sugar for long-term enjoyment.

Source: OSU Extension MFP